

Company: BlackRock

Job Profile: Aladdin Data (Data related role)

Offer Type: Internship + PPO

Internship Stipend: 50K

CTC: 18 LPA

Location: Mumbai/Delhi (allotted as Mumbai)

Process Date: OA - 22/08/25, Interviews – 28/08/25

Placement Process:

The process consisted of 3 rounds 1 Test and 2 technical rounds. The Entire process including interviews was online.

OA on 22/8/2025

Interviews 2 rounds on 28/8/2025.

Eligibility criteria was 7.5+ CGPA. I would recommend to maintain CGPA of 8 which is eligible for almost all companies except for few.

Preplacement Talk was conducted on 20/08/25. And this was a Pool Campus Recruitment Drive.

1. OA Round [100+ Candidates]

Test was conducted on eLitmus platform and it was camera proctored. Duration was 1.5 hrs consisting 3 sections. Since BlackRock visited our campus for the first time, we didn't had any previous interview experience so I searched on Web and Interview experience in YT to prepare and understand the pattern. The actual test pattern was similar to what I researched.

1. Aptitude section.

- It consisted of Quantitative Aptitude, Data interpretation and Logical Reasoning.
- The key point here is that calculators were not allowed, so you need to be fast with your mental maths and logic.
- Practising various questions and giving mock aptitude test on any online platform will help you to develop quick maths skill.
- Also prepare all types of aptitude topics because which type of question can come you never know.

2. Technical/Programming.

- This was not a coding section, but an MCQ based on coding/programming questions. It consisted of 2 types: Flowchart and Pseudocodes.
- Guess the output of code snippet and guess the output of flowchart were asked. Flowchart were not easy for sure. They were complicated and require practice to tackle such kind of questions. Some questions were fill in the blanks in flow chart.
- Pseudocodes were on Data Structure operations mostly related to Trees.

3. SQL Section –

- It consisted of SQL Code snippets. It was actually Oracle SQL which has slightly different syntax but overall logics were same.

- I suggest cover every topic of SQL right from basics, joins, subqueries etc. In MCQ, options are very closely differentiated from each other, so firm remembrance of syntax and logic is important for time-based questions.

Overall, Test was moderate level and balanced. Time management is very important, you need to be very fast in identifying the logic, calculating the maths for quant questions, imagining the outputs and understanding the code snippets. Practicing such questions beforehand boosts confidence and improves critical thinking ability.

2. **Technical Interview Round 1 (Online)** [25 to 30 were shortlisted (including waitlisted students)]

My first interview round began with a polite greeting and a brief introduction about myself. I prepared my introduction which aligned with the role offered, matching my skill set with the role and showed that I am interested in this role. Then a follow-up question was asked based on my work experience, what skills I gained, and what were my learnings there. Then the conversation moved on to the projects in my resume. Imp pointer – Always put the project which you are very confident about in the first place. I was asked for an overview of all projects mentioned in my resume and a detailed explanation of the first project. In-depth questions were asked regarding the project. It was an ML project, so questions related to Python, which library was used, which model was used, why that model, what were the results, what were the challenges, how the dataset was formed, etc., everything in depth was asked. Also, they asked twisted questions like if dataset columns are changed or a new column is added, then how the model will react. Then what was the outcome of the project, what problem does it solve, etc. Make sure to know the in-and-out of your project (also about the coding part) so that you can answer confidently. I was asked to explain a function of my project code.

Next, the interviewer jumped to the coding part and asked me to open an online compiler and gave a question to code in Python. I was familiar with CPP, so I asked him and coded the solution in CPP. He then changed the input array and asked me to print the solution. Then he asked about time and space complexity, then how I can optimize it, and so on. The question was easy – print the frequency of each element.

At last, the interviewer asked me about what BlackRock does and why I wanted to join BlackRock. Then he asked me how I stay updated about Finance and AI. Luckily, I used to read the news, so I was able to answer. He asked for any latest news regarding AI, and I answered him with three news. Then the interview ended, and I was given an opportunity to ask them any questions. So I asked them two appropriate questions. Overall, the interview went very well. My preparation helped me to answer confidently in the interview.

3. **Technical Interview Round 2 (Online)** [15-16 students approx]

My second round was a little bit stricter than the previous round. The interviewer directly asked me for my introduction and straightaway asked me a DSA question. He asked me which language I code in and to name the data structures of that language. Then he asked me some micro questions which then layer by layer ended up asking the “Kth largest element” question and its optimization. Then he asked scenario-based questions which were based on HashMaps. Then he asked OOPS concepts. Then again, I was grilled on the first project mentioned in the resume. Similarly, in round 2 also, the interviewer manipulated my project inputs and project dataset and asked how my project would perform on manipulated data. This conveys that you should know each and every function, code, input-output scenario, and limitation of your project. Overall, the interview went medium (according to me). But answering confidently and being transparent would have impressed the interviewer even though he was strict.

Also, always keep a smiling face and do not show your anxiety or fear. A happy and good conversation between you and the interviewer always results well.

4. Temporary Round [10 students]

On the interview day, i.e., 28 Aug, all results were already announced to the TPO. However, an AI copy-case incident happened during our interview rounds. The company caught some candidates using AI, which was very clearly evident to them. So, they decided to cancel the recruitment from SPIT. We all were tensed and anxious because, due to some candidates, everybody would have to suffer.

So, the next day, Sikka Sir called 10 students for the next round, and Sikka Sir took an HR kind-of interview of us. Later, they discussed the copy-case incident and how they convinced the company not to cancel recruitment from SPIT, as BlackRock was visiting SPIT for the first time. After a stressful situation, Sikka Sir finally announced the names of the selected candidates, and we were very happy. The ones who copied using AI were straightaway rejected from the process.

[Total 10 selected students → 6 for SDE + 2 Aladdin Data + 2 Global Marketing]

Useful Tips:

1. Placement preparation should start 3–4 months prior to the placement season. You can do it during your 5th semester. Preparing 1 month before placements will create huge pressure and stress. You will get no time to learn before OA or Interview Day. Ultimately, it depends on you how you manage your time.
2. If preparing for non-tech, do not fully rely on non-tech roles, as only 10% of roles are non-tech and 90% of jobs on our campus are tech roles (a mix of SDE and data roles). Always have a backup and prepare for the tech side by side. Read my story below to avoid this mistake.
3. Practice DSA and Aptitude and be well-versed before the placement season begins. It cannot be done one night prior or one week prior. And DSA & Aptitude done one night prior cannot help you clear OAs easily.
4. Once the OA-related part is cleared, focus on practicing for interviews. Try to give mocks to friends or try to improve communication skills in front of a mirror.
5. Prepare an approximate 2–3 minute introduction talking about your academics, internship/work experience details (showing its significance and what impactful work you have done), academic achievements (if any), and your interest in the role offered. This is the starting punch in which the interviewer understands you as a whole, analyzes the candidate, and prepares the next consecutive questions.
6. Always have a smile on your face and try to connect with the interviewer instead of just answering questions like a robot. Do not panic or be nervous, try to handle the situation.
7. Always ask effective questions to the interviewer at the end. Frame questions that can impress the interviewer and leave a lasting impression. Asking questions also shows that you are curious about the company. Do not ask vague or very basic questions.
8. Be very well-versed with the projects you prepare or put in your resume. You can expect deep questions about them. Diversify your projects, which will help you apply for various roles.
9. Usually, people say “do not compare yourself with others,” and that’s true—comparing yourself with others will always put you under stress and pressure. But what I would suggest is just keep a short analysis of your competitions, so that you know you need to perform better to clear tests & interviews.
10. Balance your preparation. Do not focus on only one skill. For eg. Do not do ONLY DSA & no Dev and Similarly do not do ONLY Dev & no DSA. Balance both things, plus additional CS Fundamentals and AIML concepts.
11. Do not get depressed by rejections. Rejection is a part of placements, and every rejection gives a learning. You should not give up and should keep trying again and again. Switch ON your beast mode and never settle until it is achieved. Trust on God’s plan. Even God takes our exam before giving results.
12. Always remember, placement is the joint result of hard work and luck. Luck is not in our control, but hard work is in our control. And Hard work increases the probability of Luck favouring you. You need to put in all your efforts to stand out from the crowd. AND if you are lazy and unambitious, then trust me you are already behind in the race.

Back Story –

My story is that I was purely preparing for JPMC non-tech roles during my third year, and I was not focusing much on tech roles. I was confident enough and took a risk that I would prepare for JPMC ONLY and get selected there. But things became uncertain, my resume didn't even get shortlisted for JPMC. I had thoroughly prepared for the OA, GD, interviews, and many more, but I was not even able to cross the initial step, i.e., resume shortlisting. That was a depressing night for me.

After that, I was unable to clear tech role OAs (because I was less prepared) and kept getting rejected. So, I decided to give my best at that moment and started very hard preparation for tech roles. Meanwhile, by that time, I already had an inclination towards data-related roles because I was also interested in machine learning and data science. So next, I purely focused on clearing OAs. I prepared all the stuff that is required for OAs and practiced aptitude. Companies were coming, I was getting rejected, companies were running out, but parallelly I was preparing harder.

After much efforts, the time came when I was finally able to clear my first OA, which was BlackRock, and I was confident enough for the interview (not overconfident) that I could be able to impress Interviewer. Interview is nothing but selling yourself. I prepared all the stuff related to the data role (as I was shortlisted for Aladdin Data) and prepared each and everything about my resume, my projects and technical concepts. I gave the interview confidently. Later, the results came out, and I was able to enjoy the fruit of my hard work.

General Advice –

Decide what you want to pursue Tech or Non tech. Tech people need not worry much because there will be a greater number of opportunities. But for Non tech people, kindly note that opportunities for Non tech are fewer and limited. So if preparing for Non Tech, then also prepare for Tech side by side as a backup. Luck plays a very vital role and you never know what is the next move of your luck. The only thing you can do is be an ideal person who has knowledge of all skills and be ready for every kind of job. At the end, you are the captain of your own destiny.

Placement Observations –

Below are the observations that I found during placements, and these can help you note down things in advance. THIS IS JUST an observation, do not rely completely on it.

1. The average hiring ratio is 5:1. Example – if 30 students shortlisted for interviews, then on avg 5-6 students will be selected. The number can be higher or lower as well, but averagely its 5:1.
2. Copying can be very risky. If found, you might not be able to sit for next 2-3 companies (which may be good companies).
3. Students with ONLY DSA skills were unable to answer web development questions in interviews, and students with ONLY development skills were unable to answer DSA questions in interviews. You need to prepare both.
4. There's no fix date or time of any company. Anybody can come anytime. Or even may not come.
5. Communication skills matter most in interviews and GDs. Even if you are intelligent but unable to convey your answers, you might not move forward.
6. You might see your friends or peers getting placed, but you should not take that as depression. Depression will slow down your productivity and willingness. Instead, you should learn from your mistakes, learn from your peers, put in more efforts, do not give up and achieve your goal.
7. Things to consider about Bad Luck –
 - You might not get selected in your dream company.
 - Your resume might not get shortlisted even being perfect.
 - Your server may crash during test and you are out.
 - You might get hard/strict panel for interview.
 - Your interview might get scheduled in the last slot. By the time your slot comes, the company may have already made decisions.
 - Undeserving students might get shortlisted.
8. About Good Luck - it will come surprisingly.

Resources:

These are general resources for both roles. You can also refer individual company interview experience sheet and previous year sheets for more detailed prep.

Tech and Data Roles -

1. DSA/Coding – Striver's A to Z sheet. If not able to complete full sheet then atleast try to cover concepts from each topic from the sheet. Problem solving on Leetcode, HackerRank etc platform. For SQL you can do basics on <https://sqlbolt.com/> and advance on SQL 50 on Leetcode. For OOPS and CS Fundamentals like DBMS, OS, CCN you can refer any resources of your own.
2. Projects – hackathon project or any impactful project which can impress interviewer. For data roles, you can do analytics or machine learning project.
3. Aptitude – Indiabix, GFG. Refer each topic of indiabix individually from YT or any other resource. Practice aptitude as much as possible because practice only can help you solve questions in OA quickly, with fast calculation, saving time, completing all questions and build confidence for even selecting tukka option.
4. Puzzles – refer GFG puzzles.
5. For data roles, make sure to do machine learning concepts and implement models for better understanding.

Non tech Roles –

1. Aptitude – same as like mentioned above. Also do current affairs, market awareness of last 1 year.
2. Finance, Case Study, Guesstimate – Best resource sheet prepared by my senior. Refer this. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Nwf3VM4tBb92TxsgUxDtghXyLeSLHU_v/view?usp=s
3. Additional resources –
 - This is all-in-one course for Finance. No other course required - <https://www.coursera.org/specializations/finance-and-financial-markets>
 - Note that only JPMC requires Finance knowledge. Rest other Non Tech roles require knowledge of Consulting, Marketing, Supply Chain, Markets & Economics etc. So you can practice Case Studies of various non tech fields.
 - For puzzles refer GFG top 20, top 50 etc. and for guesstimates you can refer this YT - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g7nvHCYzXQE&list=PL-q2MNxDekiSFUNcwCI-Q4-QqHWe5K42p>
 - You can learn Finance from Valuation School YT Channel. You can also do courses on Financial Risk Management (which is required for JPMC CR).

Check your resume score on – resumeworded site. Try to keep above 65-70.

It has limited no. of attempts, so use attempts wisely.

All the Best to everyone!

Be honest with your struggles and give your best.

You can connect me -

Email – vinay.marathe23@spit.ac.in

Contact - 7796160414

LinkedIn - www.linkedin.com/in/vinay-marathe